

SYNTHETIC SAMPLE — EVERY FIGURE ON THIS PAGE IS MADE UP

This is not your data, and it is not benchmark data. It describes a fictional person we invented to show what a review looks like, and nothing in it came from any real bank, card or e-wallet account.

Spending review — fictional example “P0”

Period: **1–30 September (synthetic)**. Prepared by hand. Six pages. Every number is followed by the transactions it came from, so you can check any of it.

IF YOU READ NOTHING ELSE

Every “you” below is **P0**, the invented person this sample describes — not you, the reader.

1. You spent **RM1,635.50** on yourself in September — not the **RM5,145.50** your accounts show. The gap is RM3,510.00 of card repayment, own-account transfers, investment and commitments. *(part 1)*
2. Your commitments were **RM1,180.00**, and you set aside **RM800.00**. *(part 1)*
3. The largest thing you could change without changing anything structural is food delivery: **8 orders, RM287.60** in the month. *(flag 2)*
4. **We could not see cash at all**, and we cannot follow the RM300.00 moved to savings. RM1,635.50 is our best count, not a certainty. *(part 1)*

Two things to know before you read on.

1. A dash — on this page means *we could not see it*. It never means zero.
2. Every number shows the transactions it came from and how it was worked out. **If we got something wrong, we want you to catch it.** Please cross it out and tell us.

PART 1 OF 4

What we counted as personal spending **SYNTHETIC**

Money leaving the accounts is not the same thing as money spent. We started from everything that went out — 36 outgoing lines — then took out the things that are not personal spending.

LINE	AMOUNT (RM)	WHY
Everything that left the accounts	5,145.50	Starting point. This is the number most tools show you
– Credit card bill payment (#21)	1,240.00	Paying the card is not a purchase. The card charges are already counted where they happened. Counting the bill too would count them twice
– Moves between your own accounts (#7, #32)	500.00	Moving money to your own e-wallet or savings is not spending it. The e-wallet purchases themselves are counted
– Investment transfer (#3)	500.00	Money set aside, not consumed. Calling it an expense makes saving look like overspending
– Paid back to you for the shared dinner (#12 less #13)	90.00	You paid RM180.00 and were paid back RM90.00. Only your RM90.00 share is counted
– Commitments, shown separately (#2, #4, #5, #6)	1,180.00	Real money, but not discretionary this month — rent, internet, mobile, insurance. Kept out of “spending you can change”

LINE	AMOUNT (RM)	WHY
Personal spending we counted	1,635.50	

We took these out of “spending you can change”, not out of your life. They are real money, and here they are.

WHAT WE TOOK OUT, SHOWN SEPARATELY AS PROMISED

your commitments this month rent 900.00 + internet 100.00
+ mobile 60.00 + insurance 120.00 = **1,180.00**
money you set aside investment 500.00 + to savings 300.00 = **800.00**
(the 300.00 is the one we cannot follow – see “what we could not see”)

HOW THAT TOTAL WAS REACHED – THE SUBTRACTION, IN THE ORDER OF THE TABLE

5,145.50 – 1,240.00 – 500.00 – 500.00 – 90.00 – 1,180.00 = **1,635.50**

of which one-off (air fryer, #25) 249.00
so recurring personal spending 1,635.50 – 249.00 = **1,386.50**

You should not have to trust that subtraction. Here is the same RM1,635.50 reached the other way round – by adding up what it was actually spent on:

THE SAME TOTAL, ADDED UP INSTEAD OF SUBTRACTED

groceries 622.20 + delivery 287.60 + transport 223.40
+ air fryer 249.00 + your dinner share 90.00 + pharmacy 47.30
+ lunches 41.50 + coffee 40.50 + cinema 34.00 = **1,635.50**
(transport = 4 tolls 38.40 + petrol 95.00 + petrol 90.00)

the two routes agree, so the subtraction above has no arithmetic hole in it

Every percentage on this page is worked out against RM3,120.00 — your income after commitments and the fixed investment — not against the RM4,800.00 salary. If you divide by 4,800.00 you will get different numbers from ours.

The headline. The starting figure is **3.1 times** the real one: $5,145.50 \div 1,635.50 = 3.15$. After commitments and the fixed investment your income was $4,800.00 - 1,180.00 - 500.00 = \text{RM}3,120.00$, so personal spending was $1,635.50 \div 3,120.00 = 52.4\%$ of it, leaving **RM1,484.50** unspent this month — or RM1,733.50 if you set the one-off aside.

HOW WE COUNTED THE SHARED DINNER — AND HOW IT COULD BE WRONG

We did not work out your share from the size of the bill. We used only what actually moved: you paid RM180.00 on 7 September (#12), RM90.00 came back on 8 September (#13), so we counted **RM90.00**. That choice can be wrong in two directions, and only you can say which:

If the RM90.00 was *not* a settling-up and the whole bill really was yours, we have undercounted by RM90.00 and personal spending is $1,635.50 + 90.00 = \text{RM}1,725.50$. If you are *still owed* money, your share is smaller than RM90.00 — and we cannot put a number on that end, because we cannot see a repayment that has not happened.

WHAT WE COULD NOT SEE

These are gaps in what was visible to us, not amounts of zero.

ITEM	AMOUNT (RM)	WHAT WE KNOW
Cash spending	—	No cash withdrawal and no cash purchase reaches this record at all. There may have been none, or there may have been a great deal
A second card, if one exists	—	We can see one card. If there is another, everything charged to it is missing from every figure on this page

ITEM	AMOUNT (RM)	WHAT WE KNOW
What happened to the RM300.00 moved to savings (#32)	300.00	We can see the RM300.00 leave the account, so it keeps its amount here. We cannot see what happened after it arrived. If it was spent from the other account, personal spending is understated by up to RM300.00
So RM1,635.50 is our best count, not a certainty. Cash is entirely invisible to us, and up to RM300.00 more may have been spent out of the savings account without our seeing it — which would put the real figure as high as RM1,935.50.		

CHECK US: Do those exclusions look right to you? Is there something else we should have taken out — or something we took out that really was spending?

PART 2 OF 4

Three things we flagged **SYNTHETIC**

Flag 1 — Your own numbers were hiding behind your card payment: RM3,510.00 of what looks like spending is not spending

This is a finding about *measurement*, not about a habit. Four different kinds of movement were sitting inside the figure that looks like “what I spent”.

REF	DATE	DESCRIPTION	AMOUNT (RM)
#21	15 Sep	Credit card repayment	1,240.00
#7	4 Sep	E-wallet reload from your own bank account	200.00
#32	25 Sep	Transfer to your own savings	300.00
#3	2 Sep	Investment auto-debit	500.00
#2	1 Sep	Rent	900.00
#4	2 Sep	Internet bill	100.00
#5	3 Sep	Mobile postpaid	60.00
#6	3 Sep	Insurance	120.00
#12 #13	7–8 Sep	The half of the dinner that was paid back to you	90.00
Total that is not personal spending			3,510.00

HOW THE NUMBERS WERE REACHED

card repayment 1,240.00 + own-account moves (200.00 + 300.00) 500.00
+ investment 500.00 + commitments (900.00 + 100.00 + 60.00 + 120.00) 1,180.00
+ paid back to you 90.00 = **3,510.00**

check $5,145.50 - 1,635.50 = 3,510.00$ the two agree
how much too big the starting figure was $5,145.50 \div 1,635.50 = 3.15$

This proves nothing about how you spend. It proves that the number you were probably working from was about three times too big — so anything you concluded from RM5,145.50 was concluded from the wrong number. How big the gap is depends on how you pay: RM1,240.00 of it exists only because a credit card is used as a payment rail, and RM500.00 only because there is an investment auto-debit. Someone with neither would see RM1,770.00 here, not RM3,510.00 — still most of a month's apparent spending, but not three times over.

CHECK US: Is every one of those nine rows really *not* spending? If you think one of them is, say which — it moves the RM1,635.50 straight away.

Flag 2 — Delivery is your largest changeable line, and it is smaller than it feels: 8 orders, RM287.60

REF	DATE	DESCRIPTION	AMOUNT (RM)
#9	5 Sep	Food delivery	32.90
#15	9 Sep	Food delivery	28.70
#18	12 Sep	Food delivery	41.20
#23	16 Sep	Food delivery	36.40
#26	19 Sep	Food delivery	33.80
#29	22 Sep	Food delivery	39.90
#33	25 Sep	Food delivery	30.60
#36	28 Sep	Food delivery	44.10
Total in this period, 8 orders			287.60

HOW THE NUMBERS WERE REACHED

$32.90 + 28.70 + 41.20 + 36.40$
 $+ 33.80 + 39.90 + 30.60 + 44.10 = 287.60$
average per order $287.60 \div 8 = 35.95$
share of income after commitments and investment
 $287.60 \div 3,120.00 = 0.092 = 9.2\%$

for comparison, 4 grocery trips (#8, #19, #28, #37)
 $186.40 + 142.85 + 164.25 + 128.70 = 622.20$

WHERE WE ARE GUESSING

We are flagging this because it is the largest line you could move **without changing anything structural** — not because 9.2% is alarming. It is not alarming.

We also do not know what any of these orders replaced. Some may have been days you would have bought lunch out anyway, in which case the saving from changing them is smaller than it looks.

CHECK US: Are all eight of those really food delivery? Cross out any that are not — the RM287.60 and the RM35.95 average both move if even one is wrong.

Flag 3 — Your food spending is RM36.06 a day, if you want a daily number

This is the whole food picture — groceries, delivery, coffee, lunches out, and your share of the one shared dinner. Not just eating out.

REFS	DESCRIPTION	AMOUNT (RM)
#8 #19 #28 #37	Groceries, 4 trips	622.20
8 rows see flag 2	Food delivery, 8 orders	287.60
#16 #22 #31	Lunches out, 3	41.50

REFS	DESCRIPTION	AMOUNT (RM)
#11 #30 #38	Coffee, 3	40.50
#12 #13	Your share of the 7 Sep dinner	90.00
Total food, 30 days		1,081.80

HOW THE NUMBERS WERE REACHED

$622.20 + 287.60 + 41.50 + 40.50 + 90.00 = 1,081.80$

$1,081.80 \div 30 \text{ days} = 36.06 \text{ a day}$

without the one shared dinner, which some people would call social rather than food: $991.80 \div 30 = 33.06 \text{ a day}$

If you want a daily allowance to steer by, RM36.06 is the figure it should be set against. A number below RM36 is a cut, not a budget — and we are not proposing one.

CHECK US: Is that the whole of your food? Anything bought in cash is missing from it, and cash is invisible to us.

WHAT WE DELIBERATELY DID NOT FLAG

The RM249.00 air fryer (#25). A one-off purchase. We will not turn it into “RM3,000 a year” because we have no idea how often you buy one.

Coffee at RM40.50 a month (#11, #30, #38). Too small to be worth your attention at this income.

There is no universal threshold at which a purchase becomes extravagant. These judgements are made against your income, your commitments and what you have told us you want — and they change if those change. **If you think we were wrong to leave either of these out, say so.**

PART 3 OF 4

One thing you could change, with the arithmetic SYNTHETIC

This follows from flag 2, because it is the largest line you could move without changing anything structural. It is one option, not a recommendation.

Swap 3 of your 8 delivery orders for meals cooked from the groceries you already buy.

HOW THE SAVING WAS WORKED OUT

average delivery order $287.60 \div 8 = 35.95$ (from flag 2)

assumed cost of a home-cooked equivalent 8.50 ← an assumption, not from your data

saving per swap $35.95 - 8.50 = 27.45$

3 swaps in a month $27.45 \times 3 = 82.35 \text{ a month}$

if it held for a full year $82.35 \times 12 = 988.20 \text{ a year}$

WHAT WE GUESSED — IF EITHER GUESS IS WRONG, THE NUMBER IS WRONG

- RM8.50 a meal.** We have not measured what cooking actually costs you; we picked a figure. Tell us yours and the arithmetic above runs again on it.
- Three swaps out of eight.** We do not know that three is realistic, or that those particular orders were the skippable ones. If only one swap a month is realistic: $27.45 \times 1 = \text{RM}27.45 \text{ a month}$, not RM82.35.

So under our own guesses the honest range is RM27.45 to RM82.35 a month. The RM988.20 a year is an upper bound that assumes the change holds every month for twelve months, and habit changes usually do not hold all year.

Two things this is not. It is not a claim that you cannot afford delivery — on these numbers you comfortably can. And it is not advice to stop. It is the one lever in this month's data large enough to be worth naming, and we have

deliberately not turned it into a target or a budget.

PART 4 OF 4

Three questions back to you **SYNTHETIC**

These are the answers that would change this page the most.

1. Did the RM1,240.00 card payment on 15 September cover the charges shown here, or earlier ones?

Your card was charged RM1,437.50 this month and RM1,240.00 was repaid — so at least RM197.50 of this month's charges was still outstanding at month end, whichever period the payment was for. If the payment covered an earlier period, more than that is unpaid and your real position this month is worse than this page shows.

WHERE THE RM197.50 COMES FROM — THE CARD ROWS

120.00 + 186.40 + 180.00 + 95.00 + 142.85 + 34.00
+ 90.00 + 249.00 + 164.25 + 47.30 + 128.70 = **1,437.50**
(#6, #8, #12, #14, #19, #20, #24, #25, #28, #35, #37)
1,437.50 - 1,240.00 = **197.50**

2. Did the RM300.00 you moved to savings on 25 September stay there?

If it was spent from the other account, personal spending is understated by up to RM300.00 — RM1,635.50 would become as much as RM1,935.50, and the 52.4% would become 62.0%. We cannot see it either way.

3. Was the RM90.00 you were paid back the full amount you were owed for the dinner?

If the whole bill was really yours, personal spending rises by RM90.00 to RM1,725.50. If you are still owed money, your share is smaller than the RM90.00 we counted — and that is the one end of the range we cannot put a number on ourselves. See “how we counted the shared dinner” in part 1.

ALSO WORTH TELLING US: anything on this page that is plainly wrong, and anything you expected to see here that is missing.

SYNTHETIC DATA — EVERY FIGURE ON THIS PAGE IS INVENTED. “P0” is not a real person. Nothing here came from a real bank, card or e-wallet account, and none of it is benchmark or average data for anyone. No bank, card, e-wallet or merchant is named anywhere on this page — only the type of account, which is all the figures depend on.

A dash (—) means we could not see it. It never means zero. Hatched boxes mark places where our view was incomplete.
Prepared by hand for a research conversation. Nothing on this page is financial or investment advice.